

D494

Data and Information Governance

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

At a regional insurer with 2,000 employees, the claims data has conflicting definitions of “open claim.” The VP of Claims is accountable for the data; the database administrator manages backups; a claims analyst who has been there 12 years maintains definitions and resolves quality issues. Which role is the analyst playing?

- A. Data consumer
- B. Data owner
- C. Data custodian
- D. Data steward

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Who is accountable for approving access to a data domain and for its classification?

- A. Each end user for themselves
- B. The data owner
- C. The data custodian
- D. The data steward

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A hospital’s governance policy sets a 7-year retention period for billing records. The records sit on a storage array bought in 2017. A department wants to keep 12-year-old billing records “just in case.” With no legal hold in place, what should happen?

- A. Dispose of them securely under the retention schedule and document it.
- B. Move them to an archive indefinitely.
- C. Delete all billing records older than 1 year.
- D. Keep them forever, since more data is always safer.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A university classifies data as Public, Internal, Confidential, or Restricted. A research team with a large federal grant wants to keep a file of student Social Security numbers on a shared drive. The team's lead is a well-known professor. How should the file be handled?

- A. Classify it as Confidential and keep it on the shared drive.
- B. Allow an exception because of the professor's standing.
- C. Classify it as Internal, since only staff will use it.
- D. Classify it as Restricted: encrypt it, limit access to named people, and keep it off the shared drive.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

An online retailer's order database is backed up every 4 hours, and restoring and validating it takes 6 hours. Its data center is in a Tier III facility. Leaders say they can lose at most 1 hour of orders and be down at most 8 hours. Which requirement does the current setup fail?

- A. It fails the RTO and meets the RPO.
- B. It meets both.
- C. It fails both.
- D. It fails the RPO and meets the RTO.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Leaders set an RPO of 15 minutes for a system. What does that require?

- A. Backups or replication at least every 15 minutes.
- B. Zero data loss under all conditions.
- C. Daily backups.
- D. Restoring service within 15 minutes.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A small accounting firm with 45 staff and a new office lease keeps its nightly backup on a second disk in the same server. Ransomware encrypts both. Which practice would have prevented the total loss?

- A. The 3-2-1 rule: three copies, two media types, one offsite or offline.
- B. A third disk in the same server.
- C. Backing up more often to the same disk.
- D. RAID mirroring.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A retailer finds the same customer stored three ways in its point-of-sale, e-commerce, and loyalty systems, with different addresses. Its loyalty app has 4 million downloads. Which governance solution creates one trusted version?

- A. Let each system keep its own version.
- B. Master data management with match-and-merge rules and stewardship to keep a golden record.
- C. Copy all three systems into a data warehouse.
- D. Delete two of the three records at random.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A clinic's patient table, stored in a system that passed its last audit, has 18% of rows missing an emergency contact phone number. Which data quality dimension is failing?

- A. Validity
- B. Completeness
- C. Timeliness
- D. Accuracy

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Phone numbers are present in every row, but 9% contain letters or have 7 digits instead of 10. Which dimension is failing?

- A.** Uniqueness
- B.** Accuracy
- C.** Validity
- D.** Completeness

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

After a flood closes a bank's operations center, built in 1985 near a river, the bank must keep processing customer payments from an alternate site with manual workarounds while IT restores servers. Which plan governs keeping payments flowing?

- A.** Only the DRP, since all payment work is IT.
- B.** The disaster recovery plan.
- C.** The business continuity plan.
- D.** The incident response plan.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which activity comes first and sets the RTO and RPO targets that both the BCP and DRP rely on?

- A.** Tabletop exercise
- B.** Buying cyber insurance
- C.** Business impact analysis
- D.** Backup configuration

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer D Concept 1

At a regional insurer ~~with 2,000 employees~~, the claims data has conflicting definitions of “open claim.” The VP of Claims is accountable for the data; the database administrator manages backups; a claims analyst ~~who has been there 12 years~~ maintains definitions and resolves quality issues. Which role is the analyst playing?

Target word: role **Decides:** Maintains definitions and quality day to day.

A	Dropped element	Consumers use data but do not maintain it.
B	Confusion set	The VP is accountable; that is the owner.
C	Adjacent category	The DBA runs storage and backups.
D	Correct	Stewards manage definitions and quality.

2. Answer B Concept 1 • transfer

Who is accountable for approving access to a data domain and for its classification?

Target word: reverse: duty to role **Decides:** Accountability sits with the owner.

A	Inverted operation	Requesters do not approve their own access.
B	Correct	Owners hold accountability and approve access.
C	Adjacent category	Custodians enforce technical controls that others approve.
D	Confusion set	Stewards carry out policy but are not accountable for the domain.

3. Answer A Concept 2

A hospital’s governance policy sets a 7-year retention period for billing records. ~~The records sit on a storage array bought in 2017.~~ A department wants to keep 12-year-old billing records “just in case.” With no legal hold in place, what should happen?

Target word: action on expired records **Decides:** They are past the retention period with no hold.

A	Correct	Retention schedules limit both cost and legal exposure.
B	Adjacent category	Archiving is still keeping them.
C	Wrong stem number	The policy says 7 years.
D	Absolute language	Over-retention adds risk and cost.

4. Answer D Concept 3

A university classifies data as Public, Internal, Confidential, or Restricted. A research team ~~with a large federal grant~~ wants to keep a file of student Social Security numbers on a shared drive. ~~The team’s lead is a well-known professor.~~ How should the file be handled?

Target word: classification and handling **Decides:** SSNs are among the most sensitive data.

A	Confusion set	One tier too low, with weak storage.
B	Camouflage	Seniority does not change the controls.
C	Adjacent category	Who uses the data does not set its sensitivity.
D	Correct	The highest tier gets the strongest controls.

5. Answer D Concept 4

An online retailer's order database is backed up every 4 hours, and restoring and validating it takes 6 hours. ~~Its data center is in a Tier III facility.~~ Leaders say they can lose at most 1 hour of orders and be down at most 8 hours. Which requirement does the current setup fail?

Target word: which target fails **Decides:** Up to 4 hours of data loss vs. a 1-hour RPO; 6 hours down vs. an 8-hour RTO.

A	Confusion set	Swaps the two objectives.
B	Inverted operation	A 4-hour backup gap cannot meet a 1-hour RPO.
C	Dropped element	Misses that 6 hours is within the 8-hour RTO.
D	Correct	$4 > 1$ hour of possible loss; $6 \leq 8$ hours of downtime.

6. Answer A Concept 4 • transfer

Leaders set an RPO of 15 minutes for a system. What does that require?

Target word: reverse: RPO to control **Decides:** RPO limits data loss.

A	Correct	No more than 15 minutes of data can be lost.
B	Absolute language	15 minutes of loss is acceptable by definition.
C	Wrong stem number	Could lose up to 24 hours of data.
D	Confusion set	That is an RTO.

7. Answer A Concept 5

A small accounting firm ~~with 45 staff and a new office lease~~ keeps its nightly backup on a second disk in the same server. Ransomware encrypts both. Which practice would have prevented the total loss?

Target word: backup practice **Decides:** No offsite or offline copy.

A	Correct	An isolated copy survives the attack.
B	Dropped element	Still reachable by the same ransomware.
C	Adjacent category	Frequency does not fix the lack of isolation.
D	Confusion set	Mirrors the encryption instantly; redundancy is not backup.

8. Answer B Concept 6

A retailer finds the same customer stored three ways in its point-of-sale, e-commerce, and loyalty systems, with different addresses. ~~Its loyalty app has 4 million downloads.~~ Which governance solution creates one trusted version?

Target word: solution **Decides:** Conflicting duplicate master records across systems.

A	Inverted operation	Keeps the problem.
B	Correct	MDM resolves the conflicts and governs the result.
C	Adjacent category	Collects the conflicts without resolving them.
D	Dropped element	Drops the rules for choosing which values survive.

9. Answer B Concept 7

A clinic's patient table, ~~stored in a system that passed its last audit~~, has 18% of rows missing an emergency contact phone number. Which data quality dimension is failing?

Target word: dimension **Decides:** Values are missing.

A	Adjacent category	Validity is about format and rules.
B	Correct	Required values are absent.
C	Confusion set	Timeliness is about how current the data are.
D	Confusion set	Accuracy is about present values being wrong.

10. Answer C Concept 7 • transfer

Phone numbers are present in every row, but 9% contain letters or have 7 digits instead of 10. Which dimension is failing?

Target word: reverse: symptom to dimension **Decides:** Values break the format rule.

A	Adjacent category	About duplicates.
B	Confusion set	Accuracy asks whether a well-formed number is the right one.
C	Correct	Values do not fit the required format.
D	Inverted operation	Every row has a value.

11. Answer C Concept 8

After a flood closes a bank's operations center, ~~built in 1985 near a river~~, the bank must keep processing customer payments from an alternate site with manual workarounds while IT restores servers. Which plan governs keeping payments flowing?

Target word: plan **Decides:** Keeping a business function running.

A	Absolute language	Manual workarounds and staff are outside IT restoration.
B	Confusion set	The DRP restores IT systems.
C	Correct	The BCP keeps critical business functions going.
D	Adjacent category	Handles security incidents, not site loss.

12. Answer C Concept 8 • transfer

Which activity comes first and sets the RTO and RPO targets that both the BCP and DRP rely on?

Target word: sequence **Decides:** Impact analysis sets priorities.

A	Inverted operation	Tests plans after they exist.
B	Confusion set	Transfers risk; does not set recovery targets.
C	Correct	The BIA ranks functions and sets recovery targets.
D	Adjacent category	Implements targets; does not set them.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	4	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	2	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	10	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	5	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	3	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	11	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	1	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Owner, steward, custodian	The data owner is accountable for a domain and approves access; the steward manages definitions and quality day to day; the custodian runs the technical storage and backups.	Calling the hands-on quality expert the owner.	Who is accountable vs. who maintains definitions vs. who runs the systems.
2	Retention and disposal	Keep records for the scheduled period, then dispose of them securely unless a legal hold applies.	Keeping everything forever “just in case.”	Records older than the retention period.
3	Data classification drives controls	The most sensitive tier, such as Restricted, gets the strongest controls, whoever is using the data.	Classifying by who uses the data or granting status-based exceptions.	SSNs, health data, or card numbers in a proposed location.
4	RPO vs. RTO	RPO is the maximum acceptable data loss (backup frequency); RTO is the maximum acceptable downtime (restore time).	Swapping the two.	Backup interval and restore duration against targets.
5	3-2-1 backups	Keep three copies on two media types with one copy offsite or offline.	Treating RAID or same-server copies as backups.	Ransomware or a disaster wipes the primary and the backup together.
6	Master data management	MDM matches and merges duplicate records across systems into one governed golden record.	Assuming a warehouse copy reconciles conflicts.	The same customer or product stored differently in several systems.
7	Data quality dimensions	Completeness = values present; validity = values fit the format and rules; accuracy = values match reality; uniqueness = no duplicates.	Calling missing values an accuracy problem.	Blank fields vs. malformed fields vs. wrong fields.
8	BIA, BCP, and DRP	The business impact analysis sets priorities and RTO/RPO; the BCP keeps business functions running; the DRP restores IT systems.	Treating the DRP as the whole continuity plan.	Manual workarounds at an alternate site vs. server restoration.

Course scope (public description): Data and Information Governance provides learners with the knowledge that establishing rules of engagement, policies, procedures, and data stewardship is essential to exercising organizational control over—and extracting maximum value from—its data assets. Good data governance helps an organization lower costs, create efficiencies, and achieve its strategic goals and objectives. Data governance provides a framework for properly managing information across the entire data lifecycle and establishes strategies in support of disaster recovery and continuity of operations. This course will prepare IT professionals to assist their organization in the definition and implementation of best practices related to the planning and implementation of managed systems that meet business, technical, security, auditing, disaster recovery, and business continuity requirements.